

to store your personal information. It uses *GNU GPG* to save the file. Open any file in Emacs with the *gpg* extension. To save it, press *C-s*, which asks for which type of encryption method to use. Just use the default option (*symmetrical encryption*) and press *OK*. This would prompt you for a passphrase for saving.

Emacs for playing music

Music can be played in Emacs using an external music player. In our case we'll be integrating MPlayer with Emacs using EMMS (Emacs Multi-Media System). First, install MPlayer.

In Linux (Ubuntu/Debian) try the following command:

```
$ sudo apt-get install mplayer
```

Clone EMMS as follows:

```
$ git clone git://git.sv.gnu.org/emms.git
```

If it fails, try the following command:

```
$ git clone git://git.sv.gnu.org/r/emms.git
```

It will clone the folder EMMS. Inside the folder, there are **.el* files inside the *lisp* folder. Copy them all to *~/emms.d/site-lisp/emms*. Find the executable of MPlayer, which is usually in */usr/local/bin/*. Then add this to your *~/emms* file, as follows:

```
(setq exec-path (append exec-path '("/usr/local/bin")))
(add-to-list 'load-path "~/emms.d/site-lisp/emms/lisp")
(require 'emms-setup)
(require 'emms-player-mplayer)
(emms-standard)
(emms-default-players)
(define-emms-simple-player mplayer '(file url)
  (regexp-opt '(".ogg" ".mp3" ".wav" ".mpg" ".mpeg"
    ".wmv" ".wma"
    ".mov" ".avi" ".divx" ".ogm" ".asf"
    ".mkv" "http://" "mms://"
    ".rm" ".rmvb" ".mp4" ".flac" ".vob"
    ".m4a" ".flv" ".ogv" ".pls")))
  "mplayer" "-slave" "-quiet" "-really-quiet"
  "-fullscreen")
```

Then type *M-x emms-play-directory* to navigate to your music directory and play files.

Emacs for social networking

If you crave a good user experience, it's better to use regular browsers for social networking. And it sometimes

becomes difficult to replicate all the functionality of a website in Emacs. Nevertheless, there's a way to circumvent some of the limitations and use social networking in Emacs.

To use Facebook, visit <http://m.facebook.com>. If you want login information to remain stored, add cookie information in Emacs.

```
(setq w3m-use-cookies t)
```

To use Twitter, download *twittering-mode.el* and store it somewhere. Add this to your *~/emms* file.

```
(add-to-list 'load-path "/PATH/TO/twittering-mode.el")
```

Emacs for amusement

Last but not least, Emacs also has lots of interesting features for amusement.

1. Type *M-x doctor* to talk to a psychologist.
2. Type *M-x tetris* to play Tetris.
3. Type *M-x snake* to play the classic snake game.
4. Type *M-x pong* to play ping pong.
5. Type *M-x mpuz* for a multiplication puzzle.
6. Type *M-x hanoi* for computer solving the Towers of Hanoi game
7. Type *M-x gomoku* to play the five-in-a-row game against the computer
8. Type *M-x dunnet* for a text-based adventure game.
9. Type *M-x life* to grow your own cell in Emacs.
10. Type *M-x butterfly* if you're a [xkcd] fan.

Where Emacs scores over the others is the fact that I rarely need to close it. One can easily customise and extend Emacs using *Elisp*, a dialect of *Lisp*. If you're convinced about the power of Emacs, let me welcome you to the Church of Emacs. If not, let's part ways with an old joke, "The Emacs operating system needs a better editor." 

References

- [1] Official website: <http://orgmode.org>
- [2] *xkcd*: <http://xkcd.com/378/>
- [3] Games: <http://www.emacswiki.org/emacs/CategoryGames>
- [4] Church of Emacs: <http://www.emacswiki.org/emacs/ChurchOfEmacs>
- [5] GNU style: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indent_style#GNU_style
- [6] Allman style: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indent_style#Allman_style

By: Tushar Sharma

The author is a software developer by vocation, a blogger by hobby and a poet by the irony of life. He is an ardent follower of FOSS and has an interest in anything that stimulates his grey matter. He can be reached at tushar@randomwits.com